



The Wii alongside the Wiimote: doomed or poised for a comeback?

even surrender. While the DS thus displays menus and stats, the Wii displays only the battle screens on your TV.

While You Were Sleeping

The Wii enters into a low-power state when not used, or switched off, much like a TV on standby. In this state the console can continue to communicate with the Internet. This always-

on connectivity is called the WiiConnect24, and will be used to stream various data to your console while you sleep, such that when you next power on the system it has downloaded new maps, or weapons, or system/game updates overnight!

Other features of the Wii include a Message Board, which allows you to leave messages for your family or to send them across the Internet. For example, the Board can notify your friends about any new games you might have purchased. The Message Board is built around a calendar, and allows you to trade photos and text messages with cell phone users. The Wii also keeps a log of the games you've played and the amount of time you've spent on each game. The Wii Message Board alongside WiiConnect24 will allow a game developer to send you custom messages for a new map or a weapon as it is downloaded to your console.

The Wii is a brave vision, but perhaps an essential one for Nintendo. It favours aesthetics and simplicity over raw power; certainly a black sheep amidst the Xbox 360 and the PlayStation 3. Through Wii, Nintendo wants everybody to enjoy games and thus expand the market. In many ways this was the only way forward for the Japanese company. Only time will tell whether fortune indeed favours the brave, and if the Wii will see Nintendo sink to hell—or rise to heaven. ■

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